

Weekly Briefing — Issue #3

Everything that mattered in AI this week, and what you should do about it.

Week of Jun 1 – Jun 7, 2026 | Prepared for Jaroslaw

The 60-second version

- **The week in one idea: the controls collapsed into AI defaults — across model vendors, ad platforms, and the browser — so the edge moved from *operating* the controls to *governing* the system.** Every domain that moved this week told the same story: the manual lever is being retired; the win is setting the system up once and keeping one guarded control to prove the AI's lift.
- **AI/all — build your personal AI operating system:** a two-gate model router, a 5-task frozen eval you can run on any new model in an hour, a persistent-memory loop, a private local model (Ollama), and grounded doc Q&A (NotebookLM). Five dailies this week were really one system — stand it up.
- **Paid — your SOPs are out of date this week.** Meta merged Manual + Advantage+ into one *Sales* flow (ASC is gone) and Google auto-links your YouTube channel after **Jun 10** unless you opt out. Two assignable actions below.
- **Design + Dev — two free, zero-risk upgrades:** Apple-smooth squircle corners in one line of CSS (corner-shape), and teach Copilot your conventions once with `.github/copilot-instructions.md`.
- **Social — the ranking lever moved:** Instagram now distributes on **sends per reach** (private DM shares), not likes. Brief for the forward, measure Sends.
- **Sharpen your edge:** the connective thread — never hand the AI the wheel without a control. A manual ad set, a frozen eval, a reviewed memory merge, a graceful CSS fallback: each one is how you trust the default without being trapped by it.

The week in one idea: the controls collapsed into AI defaults

Stop operating the levers — start governing the system

Pull the week's moves together and they rhyme. Meta retired the standalone Advantage+ Shopping campaign and made AI-on the default Sales flow. Google is auto-linking YouTube and pushing AI Max into more formats. Model vendors shipped persistent memory (ChatGPT 'dreaming') and ~100×-cheaper open weights so the model itself is becoming a commodity default. Even the browser shipped a 'premium' visual default (squircle corners) for one line of CSS. The manual lever — building the audience by hand, picking the one model, re-prompting your conventions every time — is being retired across crafts.

Synthesis, not recap: the five dailies this week weren't five unrelated tips. They were one shift seen from five disciplines.

So the operator edge moved up a level

When the platform does the optimizing, operating the controls is no longer the skill — **governing the system is**. That means: choose and judge the model (router + standing eval), give it memory and your conventions, design your inputs for the signal the AI now ranks on (the DM share, a deep creative pool), and — the non-negotiable — keep **one guarded manual control** to prove the AI's lift on YOUR work before you trust it. Set it up once; verify; then let it run.

Do this: This week's homework, in one sentence each: stand up a model router + frozen eval (AI), add a repo conventions file (dev), ship one squircle (design), fix your Meta SOPs + the Jun 10 YouTube check (paid), rewrite one brief for sends (social). Details below.

What changed, and what to do — by domain

One tight synthesis per domain that actually moved this week. Quiet domains (graphic, email, growth) are skipped on purpose.

AI tooling — five dailies that are really one system

[ai-tooling]

The week's AI plays compound into a personal operating system, not a pile of tips: **Ollama** for free/private work your data can't leave the laptop for; a **two-gate model picker** (capability/cost, then data/jurisdiction); a **release-day verdict kit** — 5 frozen real tasks you re-run on any new model to get a yes/no in an hour; a **persistent-memory loop** (distill each session to JSON, re-inject next time) so you stop re-explaining yourself; and **NotebookLM** for grounded, cited Q&A over your own documents.

Do this: Pick the two with the highest leverage and do them this week: (1) write your **model router** — one row per recurring task, the cheapest model that passes a quick eval, re-checked monthly; (2) freeze **5 of your real tasks** as a scored set so the next model launch is a one-hour decision, not a week of vibes. The rest (memory loop, Ollama, NotebookLM) layer on top.

Why it compounds: models keep getting cheaper and more interchangeable, so the durable value isn't picking today's winner — it's the harness that lets you swap winners safely.

Web dev — teach Copilot your conventions once

[web-dev]

The same 'govern the default' move shows up in code: instead of correcting the AI's framework, naming, and test style in every file, you encode the rules once and the assistant follows them on every request.

Do this: Add `.github/copilot-instructions.md` at your repo root with plain-English rules (framework/versions, naming, test library, hard always/never lines). Commit it; Copilot Chat attaches it to every request in that repo. Keep it short and concrete — vague rules get ignored.

This is the dev version of the persistent-memory play: state your context once, reuse it forever.

Web design — Apple-smooth corners, free and zero-risk

[web-design]

Chromium shipped the CSS corner-shape property (Chrome 139+, ~67% of users), so the iOS 'squircle' super-ellipse is now native CSS — no clip-path/SVG hack. Because border-radius still sets the size and unsupported browsers fall back to normal rounding, it's pure progressive enhancement.

Do this: On any button/card you already round, add the keyword next to the radius: `.btn { border-radius: 28%; corner-shape: squircle; }`. Dial it precisely with `corner-shape: superellipse(1.5)`. No @supports guard needed — Safari/Firefox degrade gracefully.

The keeper principle: gracefully-degrading CSS primitives can ship the day they hit one engine — lead with them.

Paid — your playbook is out of date as of this week

[paid · meta-ads · google-ads]

Two platform changes break existing SOPs. **Meta** merged Manual + Advantage+ into one unified creation flow; standalone 'Advantage+ Shopping' (ASC) is gone, renamed Advantage+ **Sales** with AI on by default and legacy APIs deprecating. **Google** expanded AI Max to Shopping + travel and will **auto-link your YouTube channel to Google Ads after Jun 10 unless you opt out**.

Do this: (1) Audit every SOP/onboarding doc that says 'create an Advantage+ Shopping campaign' — the new path is Sales objective with the three Advantage+ levers left on; keep one small manual ad set as a 2–3 week control to prove lift. (2) Before **Jun 10**: Google Ads → Tools → Linked accounts → review the pending YouTube link and confirm or unlink.

Treat Meta's exact learning-phase / ROAS numbers as directional — the Help Center lags real behavior; prove it on your account.

Social — distribution follows the private share now

[social]

Instagram unified its top-line metric to 'Views' and the strongest distribution signal is now **sends per reach** — how often people DM your post to a friend. A private forward is louder evidence the post is worth showing to strangers than a like or even a comment.

Do this: Rewrite the brief for the forward: a single screenshot-able takeaway, a 'send this to the person who needs it' framing, the hook in the first line/frame, and a soft CTA to share to a specific person. Then judge posts by the

Sends count in Insights, not likes.

Saves still win for evergreen/utility content — but for reach, a send beats a save beats a like.

Techniques & tools worth adopting this week — the keepers

The survivors after killing 95%. Each is a run-it-today play with a real link.

The shortlist

[\[technique\]](#)

Keeper	What it buys you	Start here
Model router + 5-task frozen eval	Judge any new model in an hour; pay frontier prices only where they earn it	Artificial Analysis / Promptfoo
Persistent-memory loop	Stop re-explaining your context every session	Distill to JSON, re-inject next chat
Ollama (local model)	Free, private AI for text you can't paste into a cloud chatbot	ollama run llama3.2
NotebookLM	Grounded, cited Q&A over your own docs — far less hallucination	Upload sources, ask in plain English
Copilot conventions file	Suggestions that already follow your stack and rules	.github/copilot-instructions.md
corner-shape squircle	Apple-smooth corners, one line, zero risk	border-radius + corner-shape: squircle

Predictions ledger — resolved & newly on the board

Resolved this week

- **[ai-tooling]** 'Compute/power is THE bottleneck' (made May 30) — reaffirmed Jun 4 by ByteDance ~\$70B infra and Anthropic ~\$200B cloud/chip commitments.
- **[ai-tooling]** The jobs-narrative reversal would settle (made May 30) — partial: instead of settling it escalated into open labor conflict across multiple jurisdictions.

Newly on the board (logged this week, still open)

- **[web-design]** CSS corner-shape ships in a 2nd engine (Safari/Firefox), putting squircles on the path to Baseline — due ~end of 2026.
- **[paid]** Meta removes the ability to create a fully-manual (Advantage+/-off) Sales campaign, making the unified flow mandatory — due ~end of 2026.
- **[social]** Instagram surfaces 'Sends' as a default top-line metric in post Insights — due ~end of Q3 2026.
- **[ai-tooling]** MiniMax M3's SWE-Bench Pro 59 claim reproduces (or not) once weights ship — due ~Jun 11; and a Claude Sonnet 4.8 refresh reprices the mid-tier — due ~2–4 weeks.
- **[ai-tooling]** **NEW weekly call:** by end of Q3 2026, at least two more major ad/creative platforms will retire a standalone manual campaign type in favor of an AI-default flow (the 'controls collapse' trend continues) — falsifiable by Sep 30.

This week's action list

Concrete and assignable, per discipline.

- **AI/all** — Write a one-page model router (task → cheapest model that passes a quick eval) and re-check it monthly.
- **AI/all** — Freeze 5 of your real tasks as a scored eval set so the next model launch is a one-hour yes/no.
- **AI/all** — Start the persistent-memory loop: distill each session to JSON and re-inject it next time.
- **AI/private** — Install Ollama and run a local model for anything you can't paste into a cloud chatbot.
- **Dev** — Add .github/copilot-instructions.md with your stack, naming, test style, and hard always/never rules.

- Design — Ship corner-shape: squircle on one button/card as progressive enhancement (keep the border-radius).
- Paid — Audit SOPs to Meta's unified Advantage+ Sales flow and keep one manual control ad set to prove lift.
- Paid — Before Jun 10: review/confirm the Google Ads → YouTube auto-link (or unlink).
- Social — Rewrite one brief to optimize for sends-per-reach and report Sends in Insights, not likes.

Sources

Ollama — run open models locally · Artificial Analysis (price/speed/quality) · Promptfoo (eval across models) · Google NotebookLM · GitHub — Copilot repository custom instructions · MDN — corner-shape · Smashing — corner-shape for UI · PPC Land — Meta unified Advantage+ · Google — AI Max · Sprout Social — Instagram algorithm 2026 · Anthropic — Building effective agents

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